

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET E — CASE STUDY & SOURCE-BASED SCENARIOS****CHAPTER 05: STATE AND SOCIETY UP TO 1000 CE**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-E-05

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET E - Case Study & Source-Based Scenarios):

1. The question paper comprises **5 In-Depth Case Studies & Source Scenarios** with **5 MCQs each (Total: 25 Questions, 1 Mark each)**.
2. Read each source passage, historical inscription, geographic case, and economic scenario carefully before answering the corresponding questions.
3. Each question has 4 options with a single correct answer.
4. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
5. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

CASE STUDY 1: ADMINISTRATIVE MACHINERY OF THE MAURYAN EMPIRE IN KAUTILYA'S ARTHASHASTRA

Kautilya's Arthashastra presents an extraordinarily sophisticated treatise on statecraft, fiscal administration, and public governance in ancient India. According to Kautilya, the sovereign state is conceptualized as an organic entity comprising seven constituent limbs (the Saptanga theory): the King (Swami), Ministers (Amatya), Territory and Population (Janapada), Fortified Capital (Durga), Treasury (Kosha), Armed Forces (Danda), and Foreign Allies (Mitra). To manage the vast imperial apparatus of the Mauryan Empire, the central administration was organized into specialized bureaucratic departments overseen by superintendents (Adhyakshas). The two most powerful fiscal officers were the Samaharta (the Chief Collector-General of Revenue, responsible for assessing land taxes, tolls, customs, and mine revenues) and the Sannidhata (the Chief Treasurer, custodian of the royal storehouses, granaries, and gold reserves). An elaborate intelligence network of secret informants (Gudhapurushas) kept constant vigil over provincial governors and royal ministers to eliminate embezzlement and detect sedition.

Q.1 What is the Saptanga theory articulated by Kautilya in the Arthashastra?

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|--|--|
| (A) A religious philosophy describing seven stages of reincarnation | (B) A political theory defining the state as an organic whole composed of seven essential elements |
| (C) A military doctrine describing seven weapons used in chariot battles | (D) An astronomical manual describing the seven visible planets |

Q.2 In the Mauryan imperial bureaucracy, what were the primary administrative duties of the Samaharta?

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|---|--|
| (A) Commanding naval war fleets in foreign oceans | (B) Serving as Chief Collector-General responsible for assessing and collecting state revenues, customs, and taxes |
| (C) Translating Greek philosophical texts into Sanskrit | (D) Constructing wooden palaces for the crown prince |

Q.3 What was the official function of the Sannidhata in the central Mauryan government?

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|--|--|
| (A) Royal ambassador stationed in foreign Greek kingdoms | (B) Chief Treasurer and custodian of imperial storehouses, granaries, and the state treasury |
| (C) Commander of the royal cavalry regiments | (D) Chief judge of the municipal family courts |

Q.4 Why did Kautilya place heavy emphasis on maintaining an extensive espionage network of Gudhapurushas?

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|--|--|
| (A) To spy on foreign kings and monitor domestic ministers to detect corruption, treason, and administrative abuse | (B) To force ordinary farmers to abandon their crops |
| (C) To steal books from university libraries | (D) To assassinate all citizens who did not belong to the royal family |

Q.5 Which core philosophical principle summarized Kautilya's ideal vision of royal duty and kingship?

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|--|--|
| (A) 'The king's pleasure is supreme, regardless of his subjects' misery' | (B) 'In the happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness; in their welfare his welfare' |
| (C) 'A king should conquer all lands without caring for law or morals' | (D) 'A king must never collect any taxes from anyone' |

CASE STUDY 2: ASHOKA'S EDICTS & HUMANITARIAN GOVERNANCE AFTER THE KALINGA WAR

The Kalinga War (c. 261 BCE) was the decisive watershed moment in the political and moral life of Emperor Ashoka. Major Rock Edict XIII, carved into granite cliffs at Girnar, Kalsi, and Shahbazgarhi, preserves Ashoka's candid personal testimony of remorse: over 100,000 soldiers were slain, 150,000 were driven into captivity, and countless non-combatant civilians, ascetics, and families suffered unspeakable grief. Deeply shaken, Ashoka abandoned aggressive imperial militarism (Bherighosha) and adopted the moral conquest of righteousness (Dhammaghosha). He instituted a new cadre of senior executive welfare officers called Dhamma Mahamattas, tasked with promoting communal welfare, inspecting judicial fairness in prisons, mitigating arbitrary punishments, and distributing royal charity across religious sects. In Major Rock Edict II, Ashoka recorded the establishment of two types of medical clinics—one for human beings and another for animals—alongside the planting of medicinal herbs, banyan shade trees, and the digging of public freshwater wells every half-kos along all major highways.

Q.6 In which royal inscriptional edict does Emperor Ashoka express profound remorse and sorrow over the carnage of the Kalinga War?

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|------------------------|------------------------------|
| (A) Minor Rock Edict I | (B) Major Rock Edict XIII |
| (C) Pillar Edict VII | (D) Bhabru Stone Inscription |

Q.7 What were the primary civic and ethical duties assigned to the newly created Dhamma Mahamattas?

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| (A) Leading cavalry assaults on neighboring peaceful countries | (B) Supervising moral welfare, ensuring prison justice, and distributing state welfare impartially across all religious sects |
| (C) Confiscating private farmland from Buddhist monks | (D) Collecting punitive taxes from impoverished peasant families |

Q.8 What pioneering public health and veterinary welfare measures are documented in Ashoka's Major Rock Edict II?

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|--|---|
| (A) Banning all medical treatment for wild animals | (B) Establishing hospitals for both humans and animals, importing medicinal herbs, and digging roadside wells |
| (C) Constructing iron factories for manufacturing spears | (D) Mandating that citizens travel only by horse chariot |

Q.9 How did Ashoka address religious diversity and pluralism in his 12th Major Rock Edict?

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| (A) He declared his own Buddhist sect supreme and banned all other religions | (B) He advocated mutual tolerance, dialogue, and respect for all religious denominations, condemning sect sectarian disparagement |
| (C) He ordered the demolition of all Hindu, Jain, and Ajivika monasteries | (D) He mandated that all citizens worship only the Roman gods |

Q.10 What scripts did Ashoka utilize in the northwestern frontier regions of his empire (such as Kandahar and Shahbazgarhi)?

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|--|--|
| (A) Modern English and German scripts | (B) Greek, Aramaic, and Kharosthi scripts to communicate with local multilingual populations |
| (C) Egyptian hieroglyphics exclusively | (D) Latin alphabet scripts used by Julius Caesar |

CASE STUDY 3: THE CLASSICAL GUPTA GOLDEN AGE & THE PRAYAG PRASHASTI OF SAMUDRAGUPTA

The 4th and 5th centuries CE under the imperial Gupta dynasty witnessed the flourishing of classical Indian art, literature, mathematics, and metallurgy. A primary historical document of this period is the Allahabad Pillar Inscription (Prayag Prashasti), composed in elegant classical Sanskrit verse and prose by the royal court poet and high minister Harishena. Inscribed upon an ancient sandstone pillar originally erected by Ashoka, the Prashasti documents the diverse military and diplomatic policies executed by Emperor Samudragupta. Rather than treating all conquered foes identically, Samudragupta adopted sophisticated differential policies: in Northern India (Aryavarta), he enforced 'Prasabhoddharana' (violent extermination and direct annexation of the kingdoms of nine rulers). In contrast, for the twelve rulers of Southern India (Dakshinapatha), he pursued 'Grahana-Moksha-Anugraha'—defeating them in battle, capturing them, releasing them graciously, and reinstating them as tributary vassals. For frontier forest kingdoms (Atavika states) and border principalities, he accepted tribute, personal attendance at court, and matrimonial alliances, maintaining vast imperial influence without overextending administrative resources.

Q.11 Who composed the famous Prayag Prashasti (Allahabad Pillar Inscription) in classical Sanskrit in praise of Samudragupta?

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|---------------|--|
| (A) Kalidasa | (B) Harishena (court poet and Mahadandanayaka) |
| (C) Aryabhata | (D) Banabhatta |

Q.12 What policy did Samudragupta adopt toward the conquered rulers of Northern India (Aryavarta)?

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|--|--|
| (A) He made them equal emperors alongside him | (B) Prasabhoddharana—violent uprooting and direct annexation of their territories into the Gupta realm |
| (C) He gifted them all imperial gold dinaras and retired | (D) He forced them to convert to foreign Mediterranean religions |

Q.13 What was the strategic diplomatic policy of 'Grahana-Moksha-Anugraha' applied to the twelve kings of Dakshinapatha (South India)?

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|--|--|
| (A) Executing all captured kings in public squares | (B) Defeating, capturing, liberating, and reinstating them as tributary subordinate monarchs |
| (C) Annexing their distant lands and stationing Gupta garrisons in every village | (D) Selling the southern kings into foreign slavery |

Q.14 What historical continuity is symbolized by the Allahabad sandstone pillar itself?

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| (A) It was carved by modern British soldiers in 1947 | (B) It bears inscriptions of the Mauryan Emperor Ashoka, the Gupta Emperor Samudragupta, and later the Mughal Emperor Jahangir |
| (C) It was transported from Egyptian pyramids by Roman sailors | (D) It was a natural tree trunk that turned into stone |

Q.15 Which gold coins issued by Samudragupta depict him playing a musical instrument, highlighting his personal artistic talents?

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|---|--|
| (A) The Horseman type coins | (B) The Veena-player type gold dinaras |
| (C) The Ashvamedha sacrifice type coins | (D) The Archer type coins |

CASE STUDY 4: GRASSROOTS DEMOCRACY IN THE CHOLA KINGDOM: THE UTTARAMERUR INSCRIPTIONS

Two 10th-century stone inscriptions carved onto the walls of the Vaikunta Perumal temple in Uttaramerur (Kanchipuram district, Tamil Nadu) during the reign of the Chola king Parantaka I (c. 919 and 921 CE) provide unprecedented historical evidence of local village self-government in medieval South India. The village, an *agrahara* (*brahmadeya*) settlement of scholarly landholders, was governed by an autonomous assembly called the *Sabha*. The inscription details the *Kudavolai* (pot-ticket) electoral system. The village was demarcated into 30 wards (*kudumbus*). Citizens in each ward nominated eligible candidates. Qualifications were strict: a candidate had to own at least one-fourth *veli* of taxable land, reside in a house built on his own land, be aged between 35 and 70 years, and possess knowledge of the Vedic scriptures and administrative accounts. Disqualification criteria were equally rigorous: anyone who had served on a committee in the previous three years and failed to submit audited financial accounts, or anyone guilty of moral corruption, theft, or sin, was barred alongside all his close relatives. On election day, names written on palm-leaf tickets were deposited into a pot (*kuda*), shaken, and drawn by an innocent young boy before the assembled village, constituting the executive committees for gardens (*totta-variyam*), tanks (*eri-variyam*), and annual justice (*samvatsara-variyam*).

Q.16 What ancient democratic mechanism for choosing village committee members is documented in the Uttaramerur inscriptions?

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| (A) Hereditary succession from father to eldest son | (B) The Kudavolai (pot-ticket) system where palm-leaf ballots were drawn from a pot by a young boy |
| (C) Appointment of committee members by royal military decrees from Thanjavur | (D) Auctioning of public administrative seats to the highest cash bidder |

Q.17 Which of the following was a mandatory qualification for contesting election to a ward committee at Uttaramerur?

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|---|--|
| (A) Ownership of taxable land, residence in a self-owned house, age between 35 and 70, and financial literacy | (B) Being the wealthiest merchant in the entire Chola empire |
| (C) Having served continuously on every committee for the past twenty years | (D) Being a commander in the Chola imperial royal navy |

Q.18 Under the Uttaramerur governance rules, who among the following was strictly disqualified from contesting?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Anyone who had never owned a gold coin | (B) Anyone who had served on a committee in the previous three years without submitting audited financial accounts |
| (C) Anyone who knew how to read and write | (D) Anyone whose family owned a farm outside the village |

Q.19 What was the Eri-variya committee responsible for in Chola village administration?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Collecting road tolls on bullock carts | (B) Management, maintenance, desilting, and distribution of water from irrigation tanks |
| (C) Conducting theatrical dance dramas for the royal court | (D) Training war horses for cavalry brigades |

Q.20 What does the existence of the Uttaramerur Sabha prove regarding ancient and medieval Indian polity?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) That all power was 100% centralized in the hands of a tyrannical king with zero public input | (B) That vibrant, highly organized grassroots local self-government and accountability mechanisms operated effectively at the village level |
| (C) That villages lacked any rules, laws, or public administration | (D) That elections were imported to India by 18th-century European trading companies |

CASE STUDY 5: SCIENTIFIC RENAISSANCE IN ANCIENT INDIA: ARYABHATA & METALLURGICAL MARVELS

The intellectual zenith of ancient India produced groundbreaking scientific and technological innovations that shaped global history. In 499 CE, at the age of 23, the astronomer-mathematician Aryabhata composed the 'Aryabhatiya' in Kusumapura (Pataliputra). Breaking with mythic orthodoxy, Aryabhata proposed that the Earth is a sphere rotating on its own axis, explaining the apparent motion of the heavens: 'Just as a man in a boat moving forward sees stationary objects moving backward, so people see the stars moving west.' He calculated the value of π (pi) as approximately 3.1416, formulated rules for calculating areas of triangles and circles, and demonstrated that solar and lunar eclipses are not caused by mythical demons swallowing heavenly bodies, but by the shadows cast by the Earth and the Moon. Concurrently, ancient Indian metallurgists achieved unparalleled expertise, evidenced by the 7-metre-tall, 6-tonne wrought iron pillar of Chandragupta II at Mehrauli, Delhi, which has stood exposed to tropical monsoon weather for over 1,600 years without rusting. This corrosion resistance is attributed to high phosphorus content and the formation of a protective passive film of crystalline iron hydrogen phosphate hydrate (misawite).

Q.21 What groundbreaking astronomical hypothesis was proposed by Aryabhata in the Aryabhatiya in 499 CE?

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|---|--|
| (A) The Earth is flat and supported on the back of four giant elephants | (B) The Earth is a rotating sphere that spins on its own axis, causing the daily motion of stars |
| (C) The Sun revolves around the Earth once every 24 hours | (D) The planets are living celestial deities that eat comets |

Q.22 How did Aryabhata explain the scientific cause of solar and lunar eclipses?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) As divine punishment caused by demonic monsters (Rahu and Ketu) devouring the sun | (B) As natural astronomical phenomena caused by the shadow of the Moon falling on the Earth or the shadow of the Earth falling on the Moon |
| (C) As optical illusions caused by dust storms in the Thar desert | (D) As sudden reductions in the internal nuclear fires of the Sun |

Q.23 What value did Aryabhata calculate for the mathematical constant π (pi)?

- (A) Exactly 1.0 (B) Approximately 3.1416, stating it is an approximation
(C) Exactly 10.5 (D) Zero

Q.24 Why has the 1,600-year-old Mehrauli Iron Pillar in Delhi remained virtually rust-free despite exposure to monsoon rains?

- (A) It is painted every morning with modern synthetic oil enamel paint (B) High phosphorus content in the wrought iron created a protective passive catalytic film (misawite) preventing atmospheric oxidation
(C) The pillar is made of solid stainless steel imported from Germany (D) The pillar was kept inside an air-conditioned museum until yesterday

Q.25 Which famous Gupta emperor's inscriptions are engraved upon the Mehrauli iron pillar in Delhi?

- (A) Ashoka Maurya (B) Chandra (identified with Chandragupta II Vikramaditya)
(C) Harshavardhana (D) Pulakeshin II

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET E)

01 (A) (B) (C) (D)	02 (A) (B) (C) (D)	03 (A) (B) (C) (D)	04 (A) (B) (C) (D)	05 (A) (B) (C) (D)
06 (A) (B) (C) (D)	07 (A) (B) (C) (D)	08 (A) (B) (C) (D)	09 (A) (B) (C) (D)	10 (A) (B) (C) (D)
11 (A) (B) (C) (D)	12 (A) (B) (C) (D)	13 (A) (B) (C) (D)	14 (A) (B) (C) (D)	15 (A) (B) (C) (D)
16 (A) (B) (C) (D)	17 (A) (B) (C) (D)	18 (A) (B) (C) (D)	19 (A) (B) (C) (D)	20 (A) (B) (C) (D)
21 (A) (B) (C) (D)	22 (A) (B) (C) (D)	23 (A) (B) (C) (D)	24 (A) (B) (C) (D)	25 (A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & CASE STUDY ANALYTICAL EXPLANATIONS (SET E)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Source Analysis & Conceptual Explanation
Q.1	(B)	The Saptanga theory defines the seven limbs of the sovereign state: Swami, Amatya, Janapada, Durga, Kosha, Danda, and Mitra.
Q.2	(B)	The Samaharta was the chief collector of revenue, responsible for assessing and collecting all imperial taxes, duties, and tolls.
Q.3	(B)	The Sannidhata had charge of the treasury, building royal storehouses, and safeguarding state granaries and precious reserves.
Q.4	(A)	Espionage was an indispensable tool of governance in the Arthashastra to preserve state security and monitor royal officials.
Q.5	(B)	Kautilya famously declared that the sovereign's happiness and duty are fundamentally bound to the welfare and security of his people.
Q.6	(B)	Major Rock Edict XIII preserves Ashoka's emotional testimony of grief, renouncing war in favor of moral conquest (Dhammaghosha).
Q.7	(B)	Dhamma Mahamattas were state ombudsmen who looked after public welfare, audited judicial fairness, and promoted communal harmony.
Q.8	(B)	Major Rock Edict II records state-funded clinics for humans and animals, importation of medicinal roots, and roadside amenities.
Q.9	(B)	Major Rock Edict XII is a historic charter of religious tolerance, urging respect for all faiths and discouraging sectarian condemnation.
Q.10	(B)	In the northwest, Ashoka's edicts were composed in Kharosthi (derived from Aramaic) as well as bilingual Greek and Aramaic texts.
Q.11	(B)	Harishena, a high-ranking court poet and minister of Samudragupta, authored the Sanskrit panegyric inscribed on the Allahabad pillar.
Q.12	(B)	In Aryavarta, Samudragupta uprooted regional monarchs and incorporated their lands directly into the imperial Gupta heartland.
Q.13	(B)	Given the logistics of controlling distant southern realms, Samudragupta wisely reinstated them as tribute-paying vassal states.
Q.14	(B)	The Allahabad pillar represents unique historical continuity, bearing inscriptions from three distinct imperial eras: Ashoka, Samudragupta, and Jahangir.
Q.15	(B)	Samudragupta issued gold dinaras depicting himself seated on a couch playing the stringed lute (veena), showcasing his artistic mastery.
Q.16	(B)	The Kudavolai system was a transparent lottery-election mechanism using palm-leaf tickets drawn before the assembled village.
Q.17	(A)	Candidates had to own property, be aged between 35 and 70, and be well-versed in both scriptures and accounting.
Q.18	(B)	Accountability was enforced by barring members who had served within the preceding three years and failed to submit audited accounts.
Q.19	(B)	The Eri-variya was the tank committee responsible for maintaining irrigation tanks, sluices, and water channels vital for agriculture.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Source Analysis & Conceptual Explanation
Q.20	(B)	The Uttaramerur records prove sophisticated, autonomous local self-government, committee systems, and civic auditing in Chola South India.
Q.21	(B)	Aryabhata correctly deduced that the Earth rotates on its own axis, explaining the apparent westward drift of the constellations.
Q.22	(B)	Aryabhata discarded mythological superstition, correctly proving that eclipses occur when shadows of the Earth and Moon eclipse each other.
Q.23	(B)	Aryabhata provided the value of π as $62832 / 20000 = 3.1416$, noting explicitly that the value is approximate.
Q.24	(B)	High phosphorus and un-slugged charcoal wrought-iron metallurgy produced a protective passive oxide/phosphate layer preventing rust.
Q.25	(B)	The Sanskrit inscription on the Mehrauli pillar commemorates King Chandra, widely identified by historians as Chandragupta II.